



BRAINLIFT

Alpha Hours

Purpose, experts, spiky points of view, insights, knowledge tree, business model, financials and rollout for a profitable after-school business unit inside Alpha buildings.

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STATUS

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AT A GLANCE

70%

of every room is families who will never enroll at Alpha. They are the business, not a leak.

4 children

on every seat after 3:30, six with the evening block, in buildings Alpha already pays for.

\$40B

a year of US tutoring and after-school spend, almost none of it from families shopping for a school.

\$101M

revenue run rate at capacity from Session 4 on the nine-campus pilot.

11,908

children on Timeback after school at full-network capacity, more than Alpha enrolls full-time.

8 SPOVs

one owner, one P&L, one number the Head is held to.

Purpose

PRIMARY PURPOSE

Design, launch and run Alpha Hours: a premium after-school program that delivers the Alpha day, mastery-based academics on Timeback followed by a life skills workshop, inside existing Alpha campuses, and sells it to the families who will never enroll at Alpha. In every city, most families will not enroll at Alpha, for reasons that have nothing to do with whether they want what Alpha does: they love their school, they cannot or will not pay \$40,000 to \$75,000, they were not admitted, the commute does not work, the siblings are somewhere else. Those families are the market. Alpha Hours sells them the Alpha day, after school, for \$22,500 a year, for as long as their child is in K-8. Families who are considering Alpha, and families Alpha has told "not yet," buy the same product in the same room, and some of them convert to full-time enrollment. That is the upside, and it is real, but the business does not depend on it. Current Alpha students, whose school day ends at 3:30, enroll on the same terms.

Families attend four hours a week: a two-night track (Monday/Wednesday or Tuesday/Thursday, 4:00 to 6:00 pm) or a single four-hour Saturday block (two are offered). Every block runs Timeback in pomodoros, 25-minute mastery sessions, ends with life skills and shoutouts, and families enroll one seven-week session at a time, five sessions a year.

Alpha Hours launches in Session 2, October 19 to December 18, 2026, in New York only: 180 Maiden Lane (100 seats) and 156 William Street (30 seats), 520 enrolled at capacity and an \$11.7M revenue run rate. Session 3 (January 4, 2027) adds Greenwich and both Boston campuses. Session 4 (February 24, 2027) adds Chicago at its expanded 517 seats and the three Florida campuses, Miami, Palm Beach and Miami Beach: nine campuses, 1,127 seats, 4,508 enrolled, a \$101.4M run rate at capacity. Session 5 runs that footprint with no new openings, and the national launch, every remaining campus, is Session 1 of Fall 2027.

THE PROGRAM EXISTS TO DO FOUR THINGS AT ONCE

1. Make money on the families who will never enroll. A premium after-school offering priced above every competitor, sold to every family in the city who will pay for it, most of whom will never apply to Alpha and never need to. The program is a P&L, and it clears its P&L at zero conversions.

2. Use real estate we already pay for, turning empty late-afternoon, evening and weekend hours in Alpha buildings into revenue.
3. Serve Alpha's own families. Almost every Alpha campus in the country ends the school day at 3:30 with nothing behind it. Alpha Hours closes that gap on every campus, and gets paid a premium price to do it. Current Alpha students enroll at the same session price with a 5 percent family discount, and transition directly on campus at the end of the school day.
4. Upside: feed Alpha. Some families in the room are deciding on Alpha, and some were told "not yet." They get a paid trial with data instead of a free shadow day, and a paid roadmap back instead of a letter. The ones who convert are worth \$160,000 to \$325,000 each in lifetime tuition. That is upside on a business that already works without it.

Success is measured on the first three: site profit and revenue, re-enrollment, building utilization, and current-family enrollment. Conversions to full Alpha are reported every session as the upside line. The Head of Alpha Hours is reviewed on the P&L first.

WHERE THIS FITS: A BILLION KIDS

Alpha's ambition is a billion kids learning this way. Campuses get there one building and one enrolled family at a time, and a full-time seat reaches one child. Alpha Hours reaches the children who will never sit in that seat. It puts four children on every seat after 3:30, six once the evening block opens, in buildings Alpha already pays for, sold to a market Alpha has never had a product for. It is a business unit with its own P&L, it sweats assets that sit dark most of the week, and it opens a new market. Each of those moves the count of children learning on Timeback, which is the number the mission is measured in.

THE MARKET: FAMILIES WHO WILL NEVER ENROLL

Alpha will never enroll 100 percent of the families in any city. It will not enroll 10 percent. In New York there are roughly 190 Alpha seats and hundreds of thousands of K-8 children whose parents can pay for a premium after-school program. The families who will never enroll are not a leftover. They are the market, and they do not enroll for reasons that have nothing to do with wanting what Alpha does:

- They love their school, and are not leaving it. Legacy, siblings, community, a religious or single-sex school, a public school they fought to get into.
- They cannot or will not pay full Alpha tuition, and can pay \$22,500 a year.
- They applied and were not admitted, or were admitted and the timing did not work.

- The commute to Alpha does not work for a full school day, and works fine for two hours or a Saturday.
- They want a traditional school and Alpha academics on the side, and are not interested in the argument.
- They are on a waitlist somewhere else, or moving, or waiting for a sibling to age in.

None of those reasons stops the family from buying Alpha Hours, and none of them changes over time. That is what makes this lane the business: it has no ceiling on tenure, it re-enrolls five times a year for as long as the child is in K-8, and it costs nothing to acquire after the first session.

THREE LANES, ONE ROOM

Every family sits in one of three lanes. The room, the guides, the block and the price are the same in every lane. What differs is what we sell the family, what we measure, and what the family is worth.

Stay. The families above, who never plan to enroll at Alpha. This is the business: the lane the program is built for, the lane the plan is sized on, and the lane the Head is reviewed on. A Stay family is a \$22,500-a-year customer for years, and we sell them exactly that: the Alpha day, after school, every session, for as long as they want it.

Considering. Upside. Families who are deciding on Alpha. They pay \$4,500 and four hours a week for seven weeks to try it, they get a mastery map and a weeks-to-grade-level projection at the end, and the structured conversion conversation fires on data. Some convert. The ones who do not are not lost. They move into Stay.

Path to yes. Upside. Families Alpha has told "not yet." Today that is a letter and a roadmap and a lost family. Now it is a seat, a roadmap with measurable thresholds, a re-evaluation date, and seven weeks of data at a time, and the family pays for it. When the data clears the bar, the child is invited to apply. If it never does, the family is still a Stay customer.

A fourth group, current Alpha families, enrolls on the same terms at a 5 percent discount and is the base load on every campus from day one.

Underneath all four sit Alpha's three commitments, and every one carries into Alpha Hours with its own measurement.

Kids love school. Underneath everything sits Alpha's first commitment, kids love school, and it carries into Alpha Hours unchanged: children love coming. This is measured by session-to-session re-enrollment and attendance, in addition to student surveys, and it is the leading

indicator for everything else. A child who begs to come back is what fills the cohorts, climbs the mastery data, keeps the Stay family for years, and converts the Considering family. Profit and conversion are the outcomes, love of the program is the engine, and we track it accordingly.

Learn 2x. Students learn at the accelerated pace Alpha holds itself to during their academic minutes. Measured by following every student's academic progress and learning velocity in Timeback, session over session. We do not promise 2x learning in one session, but promise the roadmap to 2x learning should the student enroll full-time at an Alpha School.

Learn life skills. Every session culminates in an AlphaTest Showcase, where students are tested on the life skills they have been working on, in front of their parents. The students will already be convinced by the time they have the showcase, it exists as a mechanism for convincing the parents.

OUT OF SCOPE

- Custom changes to Timeback for after-school use. The program runs the platform as built, not subject-by-subject.
- Certified-teacher tutoring models or one-on-one private tutoring. Alpha Hours cannot accommodate students who need 1:1 support, and says so publicly on the landing page.
- Test-prep-only offerings (SAT and ACT, APs).
- Non-academic enrichment (arts, sports, social clubs) as the core product.
- Full-day or full-time schooling. This is strictly after-school, Saturday, and school-break weeks.
- Online-only delivery. The program is in-person inside Alpha buildings.
- Childcare or custodial care. Alpha Hours is academic instruction, structured to qualify as instruction under state exemptions.
- Subjects beyond Timeback. Grades outside K-8 at launch; the middle and high school evening block launches Session 4 (February 2027) in New York and Greenwich and everywhere else in Fall 2027.

Experts

MacKenzie Price, co-founder of Alpha School

Co-founded Alpha in Austin in 2014 and is the public voice of the model. Built a private-school network that puts core academics on an AI platform for about two hours a day, growing from about

200 students to over 1,000 in two years across a fast-expanding campus network. She proved the Alpha model draws families at \$40,000 to \$75,000 tuition and that parents will pay for measurable results delivered by software plus guides, not teachers. Alpha Hours is her model, moved into the after-school hours.

Toru Kumon, founder of Kumon

Built one of the largest after-school brands in history, 25,000+ centers, on a simple idea, to master before you progress, and make progress visible to parents. He showed a tightly standardized, low-touch mastery system scales globally without certified teachers, and that most of his customers never wanted anything more than Kumon. Kumon is the volume baseline Alpha Hours must beat on outcomes and price, and the proof that the Stay lane is a business on its own.

Larry Martinek, co-founder of Mathnasium

Turned classroom math methods into a franchise built on trained non-teacher instructors and a fixed method. His model proves the market pays a premium for structured help delivered by trained guides rather than credentialed teachers, which is exactly Alpha Hours' staffing thesis.

Raymond and Eileen Huntington, founders of Huntington Learning Center

Built one of the first broad-subject tutoring franchises, anchored on diagnostic assessment and structured programs. They showed assessment data builds trust and justifies higher prices. Alpha Hours replaces their diagnostics with continuous Timeback mastery data, which is stronger proof delivered more often.

Michelle Rose Gilman, founder of Fusion Academy

Grew a garage tutoring program into a one-to-one private school charging roughly \$8,000 to \$17,000 per course per year. Fusion is the current price ceiling for structured academic programs below full private school, and the reference price class Alpha Hours should be compared against, not Kumon.

Command Education and Lindamood-Bell (premium-pricing reference)

Command Education charges \$120,000 a year, up to \$750,000 for a six-year package. Lindamood-Bell charges over \$10,000 for a six-week reading intensive. Both price against the value of the outcome, not hours delivered. They are the template for Alpha Hours' pricing logic: anchor on the result, quote the session number, not hourly number.

Spiky Points of View

SPOV 1

We will never get 100 percent of the families in any city to enroll at Alpha. We can make money on the ones who don't.

Alpha's growth is capped by seats and by the share of families who will ever change schools, and both caps are low. Every other family in the city, the ones who love their school, cannot pay full tuition, were not admitted, live too far, or just want what they have plus Alpha academics on the side, is written off today. Every version of an after-school feeder treats the family that stays and never applies as a leak. It is the opposite. In every city we operate in, the families who can pay \$4,500 a session and will never leave their current school outnumber the families who will ever apply to Alpha by ten to one or more. They are not a risk to the funnel. They are the business. A Stay family re-enrolls five times a year for as long as the child is in K-8, and costs us nothing to acquire after the first session. We sell them Alpha Hours on its own merits, we size the plan on them, and the families who do enroll at Alpha are the upside.

SPOV 2

Alpha Hours is a business unit, not an admissions program. It is judged on profit, fill and re-enrollment, and the school is the upside.

Every after-school idea inside a school gets built as a feeder and judged on conversions, and every one of them stays small, because a feeder can only be as big as the applicant pool. Alpha Hours is built the other way around. It is a P&L with its own Head, its own revenue, its own cost base and its own customers, most of whom will never apply to Alpha. At \$4,500 a session and about 82 percent site margin it makes money in its first session with zero conversions. Whatever admissions gets out of it is upside on top, and the Head is reviewed on the business first.

SPOV 3

The family that never switches schools is the best customer in education.

A family that enrolls at Alpha pays once a year and can leave at any renewal. A family that stays at its own school and buys Alpha Hours re-enrolls five times a year, for as long as the child is in K-8, and never has to be sold again after the first session. Their reason for not enrolling, they love their school, they cannot pay full tuition, they live too far, they were not admitted, does not change, so their tenure has no ceiling. Kumon built four million students on this customer at \$200 a month. We serve the same customer at \$4,500 a session, and it is the lane the plan is sized on.

SPOV 4

100 minutes a week and a roadmap is superior to six hours a day and a letter grade.

What 100 weekly minutes of Timeback produces something no school or human teacher in America can give a parent, a precise mastery map of where the child actually is in every subject, the child's measured learning velocity, and a computed answer to the only question that matters, which is exactly how many weeks at full Alpha until this child is at grade level, or the next one. The traditional school has the child six hours a day for years and produces a report card guessing subjectively at all of this. Seven weeks with us produces the map and the timeline. Every family who pays for Alpha Hours is running an experiment that indicts the school they already write checks to. We do not compete with Kumon. We compete with six hours of no information, and we win in seven weeks.

SPOV 5

Price against Alpha tuition, not against Kumon.

Every after-school program in America prices against the one next door: \$200 a month at Kumon, \$400 at Mathnasium, \$75 an hour at Huntington. Alpha Hours prices against the thing the family cannot or will not buy, a \$40,000 to \$75,000 Alpha seat, and sells the Alpha day after school for about a third of it: \$22,500 a year. The number is already proven, 174 paid Hamptons registrations at \$4,500 a week with one price objection. Where a cohort sells out, the waitlist reprices it by \$500 the next session, mechanically, and the pilot's job is to find out how high the ceiling is.

SPOV 6

Sell one session at a time, and you keep the family for years.

Annual enrollment is a school habit that suits families switching schools. A family that is not switching wants a low door and a product worth walking through again. One seven-week session at a time, a \$500 deposit, no application and no interview lets a family that would never fill out an Alpha application try Alpha Hours, and five re-enrollment points a year turn one good session into a multi-year customer. The annual prepay is there for the families who already know.

SPOV 7

Every building sitting empty after 3:30 PM is a waste of assets that we should be sweating.

We have buildings, owned or leased, across the country that are sitting empty for the majority of hours in the week. We should be sweating our assets to maximum capacity. Alpha Hours is just the start of a path to making money on every single available hour.

SPOV 8

Admissions is the upside, and the upside should pay for itself.

Alpha gives away shadow days, staff time and the "not yet" roadmap for free, because the school needs the families more than the families need the school. Inside Alpha Hours the trial is paid, the path to yes is paid, and the evaluation runs on seven weeks of mastery data instead of a few hours of impressions. A family deciding on Alpha pays \$4,500 a session while it decides, so the cost of acquiring a full-time student turns negative, and each conversion is worth \$160,000 to \$325,000 in lifetime tuition. That is worth a lot, and it is still upside, on a business that would be worth building if no family ever converted.

Insights

INSIGHT 1

Alpha Hours is a business unit that happens to sit inside a school. The school is the upside, not the point.

Most of every room, seven in ten families on the plan, are Stay families who were never in the admissions funnel and never will be, and they carry the site profit on their own. That is what lets the program be sized, staffed, and judged as a business: fill, re-enrollment, revenue per seat, and margin. At \$4,500 a session and about 82 percent site margin it makes money in its first session with zero conversions, and the Head is reviewed on that P&L first. The school gets three things from it without paying for any of them: trials become paid, the "not yet" letter becomes a paid roadmap, and the marketing dollars behind every inquiry are recovered inside the room. If every conversion stopped tomorrow, the P&L would not notice.

INSIGHT 2

The families who will never enroll are a new market for Alpha, and it is larger than the one Alpha sells to today.

Alpha's admissions funnel sells to one kind of family: the kind willing to change schools. In any city that is a few percent of the families who could pay. Everyone else, the families who love their school, cannot or will not pay full tuition, live too far, or were told not yet, gets nothing from Alpha, and Alpha gets nothing from them. US families spend about \$40 billion a year on tutoring and after-school, and almost none of it comes from a family shopping for a new school. It comes from families keeping the school they have and buying what it does not provide. Alpha has never had a product for that family. Alpha Hours is that product, and the full 40-campus network at capacity is 1.7 percent of the spend in Alpha's own metros, which is why the constraint is buildings and not demand.

INSIGHT 3

Sweating the assets has an order of operations. Alpha Hours is the first step in filling every empty hour, and each step after it gets cheaper.

Alpha campuses sit empty most hours of the week. Alpha Hours fills the first slice, weekday afternoons and Saturdays, and in doing so puts a trained team, insurance, and an operating playbook in place at every campus, all carried by that first program. Once that foundation exists, every other empty block, the 6:15 to 8:15 pm middle and high school block, school-break weeks, early mornings, adult evenings, can be added without rebuilding it, so each new program starts at a higher margin than the one before it. The first two additions, the evening block and break weeks, land inside Year 1 and add about \$8M at capacity on the pilot alone. Alpha Hours is not the whole building-utilization strategy. It is the first block of it, and the one that pays for the rest.

INSIGHT 4

A full-time seat reaches one child. An after-school seat reaches four. The path to a billion kids runs through the hours the building is closed as much as through the buildings Alpha has not built yet.

Alpha adds about 20 campuses a year, and each one is a lease, a build-out, a head of school and a year of admissions before the first child learns anything. Every one of those buildings goes dark at 3:30 and all day Saturday. Alpha Hours puts four children on every seat in those hours, six once the evening block opens, without a lease, a build-out or a new campus. At capacity the pilot has 4,508 children on Timeback after school across nine buildings that hold a few hundred full-time students between them, and the full network has 11,908, more children than Alpha enrolls full-time today. A billion kids will not arrive one enrolled family at a time. They come from reaching the children who never change schools, and Alpha Hours is Alpha's first product that does.

INSIGHT 5

Fill the room first, then raise the price. The waitlist sets the price, not the Head.

At \$4,500 the pilot campuses sell out or they do not, and either answer is information. A cohort that closes a session with a waitlist is underpriced, and reprices by \$500 for the following session, mechanically. A cohort that does not sell 10 seats two weeks out does not open, and its families roll into another cohort. Between those two rules the price finds the market at every campus without a single pricing meeting, and every \$500 on the session price is \$10.9M a year on the full pilot at capacity. The pilot's job is to find out how high it goes.

INSIGHT 6

The parking risk is a pricing question, not a policy question.

The old worry was that a family would treat Alpha Hours as Alpha at a third of the price and never enroll. Two things dissolve it. First, the family that parks is a Stay customer, and a Stay customer is worth \$22,500 a year for years: parking is the product. Second, the family that would have enrolled at full Alpha and is parking instead is a Considering family whose conversion conversation fires on data, not on the Head's judgment, so the invitation comes whether or not the Head wants to keep the seat. What is left is a price: from the sixth session, every seat reprices to \$5,000 in premium markets (\$4,000 standard) unless the family has an Alpha application on file, in which case the year-one rate holds. The application is the discount, not the requirement. A long-stayer is either pipeline or premium revenue, never a parked seat, and no family is ever exited for staying.

INSIGHT 7

Each lane gets its own yardstick, or the numbers lie.

A family that pays \$4,500 and commits four hours a week for seven weeks has told us far more than a family that pays \$100 and fills out a form. But if every family in the room is measured on conversion, the Stay lane looks like failure and the program looks like a leaky funnel, when it is the business. So each lane is measured on what it is for. Stay: re-enrollment, tenure in sessions, revenue per seat. Considering: conversion to full Alpha by number of sessions completed, and cost per enrollment, which turns negative because the family pays us while they decide. Path to yes: the share of families who clear their published thresholds and the share of those who are admitted. Current Alpha families: fill and re-enrollment. The Head reports all four every session, is reviewed on the P&L, and reports full-time enrollments as the upside line.

INSIGHT 8

The admissions upside pays for itself, and the data moves with the child.

Alpha gives away shadow days, staff time and the "not yet" roadmap for free, because the school needs the families more than the families need the school. Inside Alpha Hours all three are paid. A trial is a \$4,500 session. A not yet ships with a seat, a roadmap with measurable thresholds, and a re-evaluation date, so re-application becomes a data check instead of a second subjective judgment. The evaluation runs on seven weeks of mastery data instead of a few hours of impressions, and the bar is set before the session opens, so the record makes the call and the school can raise the quality of the students it admits without admitting fewer. When the family does enroll, the data comes with the child: day one starts at exactly the right level, no testing, no ramp-up. No other school's trial produces any of that, and all of it lands on top of a business that would be worth building if no family ever converted.

Knowledge Tree

Category 1: How non-school learning environments drive academic gains

Summary: Mastery pedagogy, standardized pacing, and visible progress let after school programs outperform classrooms, using process-driven personalization rather than teacher variation.

- Kumon: Founded 1954. Worksheet-based mastery, non-certified staff, 25,000+ centers, \$150 to \$220 per subject per month. Personalization lives in the process (worksheets and

standards), not the content.

- Mathnasium: Founded 2002. Trained non-teacher instructors, fixed method, math only, \$250 to \$500 per month.
- Fusion Academy: One-to-one private school, \$8,000 to \$17,000 per course per year. Proves premium willingness to pay for personalized academics.
- Alpha / Timeback / Alpha Hours: Leverages AI to deliver personalized academics equivalent/superior to 1:1 tutoring with a human, keeping each child in his or her zone of proximal development in each subject, delivering 2x learning.

Insights: Mastery scales when the system, not the teacher, carries instruction. Parents validate trust through visible, measurable progress. Premium after-school is about quality of result, not quantity of hours. Alpha Hours will provide personalized academic reports at the start and end of every session.

Category 2: After-school business models and the feeder

Summary: After-school programs scale through standardization and real-estate leverage, on families who never change schools. For a school-owned program, conversion to full enrollment is a second, smaller source of value on top.

Market size: US families already spend about \$40B a year on tutoring and after-school combined: tutoring is an \$18.9B industry growing about 11 percent annually with K-5 the fastest segment (IBISWorld 2025); after-school is \$21.0B, with 7M children enrolled and 22.6M more whose families want a spot and cannot get one (Afterschool Alliance 2025). Tutoring participation rose from 19 to 24 percent of students between 2024 and 2025, and high-income families already spend up to \$9,000 per child per year on tutoring and enrichment. Almost none of that spend comes from families shopping for a new school. It comes from families keeping the school they have and buying what it does not provide. Alpha's full 40-campus network at capacity is \$268M, well under 1 percent of what families already spend today. The constraint is buildings, not demand.

Demand evidence, bottom-up. After-school is unprompted inbound demand, not only a hypothesis. In NYC admissions conversations, families ask whether Alpha offers after-school without being prompted. In the last 14 days, 3 of 23 NYC admissions conversations included an unprompted ask for after-school, 13 percent of all conversations, with no marketing and no product to point to. Most recently last week on Wednesday, a family said they would continue with Alpha by trying it that way if after school existed. The same pattern held in my prior private-school sales role, where the after-school question came up at least biweekly across a national

territory. The demand also runs inside our own walls: Alpha parents nationwide ask what happens after the school day ends at 3:30, and today the answer is nothing. These are families telling us the entry product they want to buy before we have built it. Price acceptance is already proven at this exact number: Alpha Summer in the Hamptons has 174 paid registrations at \$4,500 per week, with one price objection total. Alpha Hours asks the same families the same number for seven weeks instead of one. New York also holds the sales list: the 1,000-plus HubSpot families from the Hamptons outreach, the 174 paid Hamptons families, and every family in the NYC admissions pipeline who was not a yes.

- Huntington: Founded 1977. Diagnostic-driven, multi-subject, \$40 to \$75 per hour. The assessments build trust and justify the price.
- Premium pricing precedent: Command Education \$120,000 a year, up to \$750,000 for a multi-year package; Lindamood-Bell \$10,000+ for six weeks; Fusion \$60,000+ full-time. All price against outcome value, not hours, and all quote the package, not the hour.
- Feeder economics: A private school typically spends \$3,700 to \$5,800 in marketing to win one enrolled student (Cube Creative Design, 2026 Private School Marketing Budget Planning Guide: industry median \$3,677, secondary \$5,844). Alpha Hours flips that: the prospective family pays us \$4,500 a session while they decide, so evaluating Alpha earns money instead of costing it. The trial is also far stronger than a shadow day. Every session ends with a conversion artifact. The child's mastery map and a personalized projection of weeks-to-grade-level at full Alpha, so the parent leaves holding a number, not an impression. Private schools typically convert 5 to 8 percent of inquiries to enrollments (Spiral Marketing, day-school benchmarks), and an inquiry is a stranger with a phone number, while every Alpha Hours family has paid \$4,500 and watched their own child's mastery data climb for seven weeks. We model conversion at 4 to 8 percent of all enrolled families, most of it from the Considering and Path to yes lanes, and Session 2 exists to replace that assumption with our own measured number. Each conversion is worth \$160,000 to \$325,000 in lifetime tuition, which is why the upside is large even at a low rate.

Insights: Standardization plus assessment builds scalable trust. Real estate already controlled is the margin. The Stay lane is the volume and the business. For a school-owned program, the feeder is upside worth more per family than the session fee, and it only functions with an intentional, structured handoff. The same room serves both.

Category 3: Sweating fixed assets, how other operators fill idle hours

Summary: Any business with a building it pays for around the clock and uses for a fraction of the week has the same opportunity: sell the idle hours to a second customer without adding fixed cost.

- After-school centers: Kumon, Mathnasium and their peers run their entire business in the 3 to 7 pm window and Saturday mornings, inside strip-mall space they lease for the whole week. The after-school hours are the business, not the leftover.
- Universities: summer sessions, executive education and conference rentals run in dormitories and lecture halls that would otherwise sit empty for a third of the year, at margins the academic year cannot match, because the buildings are already paid for.
- Churches and community buildings: weekday preschools and after-school programs are the most common tenant of a building that is otherwise used for a few hours a week.
- Theaters and airlines: matinee pricing and yield management exist because an empty seat at 2 pm costs the same to carry as a full one at 8 pm; the second customer is priced to fill it, and the marginal cost is close to zero.
- Alpha: every campus is paid for seven days a week and used for about six hours on five of them. The marginal cost of a weekday afternoon is about \$150 to \$250 and a Saturday about \$400, against \$9M a year of revenue on a 100-seat room at capacity.

Insights: The idle hours are a second business, not a discount on the first. The operator that sells them first builds the team, insurance and playbook that every later use of the building inherits. Price the second customer on value, not on the marginal cost of the room.

Business Model and Operations

The program

An Alpha day runs primarily on two things: mastery-based academics on Timeback and life skills workshops. Alpha Hours compresses that whole day into one or two blocks. A weekday block is two hours, and requires a Monday/Wednesday or Tuesday/Thursday registration. Each weekday block is organized as this: a ten-minute Limitless launch, two 25-minute academic sessions on Timeback with a short break between, a 40-minute life skills workshop, and ten minutes of shoutouts. Each of the two Saturday blocks runs the same day at double length: four 25-minute

academic sessions, an 80-minute workshop, and a snack break in the middle. Either way the child gets the same week: 100 minutes of focused, adaptive mastery academics and 80 minutes of life skills. Timeback delivers the instruction and adapts to each child. The guide holds focus, effort, and motivation, and leads the workshop. That is the whole model: the Alpha day, academics and life skills, in one or two blocks.

The lanes in operation

Every family answers one question at enrollment: are you considering Alpha full-time? Three answers: no, we love our school (Stay); yes, we are deciding (Considering); we applied and were told not yet (Path to yes, set by admissions, not the family). Current Alpha families are flagged from the roster. The lane is on the roster, the Lead Guide sees it, and the data can move a family between lanes: a Stay family whose child's mastery map shows a two-grade jump gets the Considering conversation whether they asked for it or not, and a Considering family who declines twice moves to Stay and stops getting the pitch. What the lane changes is the conversation at the AlphaTest Showcase and the report the family receives. What it never changes is the room.

The Stay family gets a re-enrollment link, the next session's schedule, and a mastery report that shows the child's progress against grade level, on Timeback data. The Considering family gets the same report plus the weeks-to-grade-level projection at full Alpha and the structured conversion conversation, which fires only when the published thresholds are met. The Path to yes family gets the report scored against their roadmap thresholds, and an invitation to apply the session they clear them.

Motivation and incentives

Alpha Hours runs the same rhythm as Alpha, starting with academics in Timeback, followed by a life skills workshop. What is different from Alpha is the child's day. The child has already been through six hours of regular school, and walks in tired at 4 pm, and needs a reason to give full effort. Alpha already has this reason, built into the model twice. The first is Timeback's own promise, carried into every block: get through your academics with focus, and the rest of the block is an amazing life skills workshop, the part of the block built around things kids actually love. The academics are the shortest path to the good part, exactly the trade Alpha kids make every day. The second is the extrinsic motivational model, and we will mirror this in Alpha Hours. Students will earn the Alpha currency for XP earned in Timeback, and will have the opportunity to purchase items in the Alpha Hours Emporium. Both motivators become even more important for

a child who has been through six hours of school: they keep the child working diligently, and boost love of Alpha Hours.

AlphaTest Showcase

Every session ends with an AlphaTest Showcase in the final week. Students are tested on the life skills they have worked on across the session's workshops, and parents come to see it. The showcase does double duty: it is how the life skills commitment gets measured instead of assumed, and it puts every parent in the building in the same week they receive their child's mastery map and weeks-to-grade-level report, which makes it the natural setting for the re-enrollment and full-Alpha conversation. No other after-school program ends a term by putting the child's growth on a stage in front of the person who paid for it.

Schedule and tracks

Runs Monday through Thursday afternoons and Saturday, inside existing Alpha campuses. The weekday block starts right where the Alpha school day ends, so the building never goes dark and every child is home for dinner.

Weekday schedule. Requires Monday/Wednesday or Tuesday/Thursday registration.

Guide setup: 3:30 to 3:45 pm (guides prepare, devices ready). Drop-off: 3:45 to 4:00 pm.

Current Alpha students transition directly on campus at the end of the school day. Block: 4:00 to 6:00 pm. Dismissal and clean up: 6:00 to 6:15 pm.

Weekday block rundown (inside the two hours): Limitless launch: 10 minutes. Academic session 1 (25 minutes). Break: 5 minutes. Academic session 2 (25 minutes). Transition: 5 minutes. Life skills workshop: 40 minutes. Shoutouts: 10 minutes. Total 120 minutes.

Saturday schedule: Setup: 8:45 to 9:00 am. AM block: 9:00 am to 1:00 pm. Transition: 1:00 to 2:00 pm (staggered pickup and drop-off; no lunch served). PM block: 2:00 to 6:00 pm. Clean up: 6:00 to 6:15 pm.

Saturday block rundown (inside the four hours): Limitless launch: 10 minutes. Academic session 1 (25 minutes). Break: 5 minutes. Academic session 2 (25 minutes). Break: 15 minutes. Academic session 3 (25 minutes). Break: 5 minutes. Academic session 4 (25 minutes). Snack break: 15 minutes. Life skills workshop: 80 minutes. Shoutouts: 10 minutes. Total 240 minutes. Four academic sessions. Snacks only, no meals.

Every campus runs four cohorts a week: Monday/Wednesday, Tuesday/Thursday, Saturday morning, and Saturday afternoon. The same room and the same guide team serve all four, and every cohort gets the same four weekly hours.

Middle and high school block (Session 4, February 24, 2027, at New York Maiden Lane and Greenwich; all pilot campuses Fall 2027; national with the build): Weekdays 6:15 to 8:15 pm, Monday/Wednesday or Tuesday/Thursday, drop-off 6:00 to 6:15, dismissal 8:15 to 8:30. Same spine as the K-8 block: Limitless launch, two 25-minute academic sessions on Timeback, then Alpha Max and Alpha X programming fills the workshop slot, shoutouts to close. The block adds two cohorts per campus and lifts the enrolled ceiling from four times room capacity to six. Staffing runs as a second part-time guide rotation, sized per campus when the block launches.

Break weeks: the same room runs a full-day week, 9:00 am to 3:00 pm, in the school-break weeks between sessions, at the Alpha Summer price of \$4,500 a week. The first is April 19 to 23, 2027, across every pilot campus. From Year 2, two break weeks a year at every campus. One seat per child, no cohort multiplier.

Capacity

Room capacity is the seats filled at one time, set per campus. Enrolled students per campus is four times the room capacity: two weekday tracks plus two Saturday blocks. A 100-seat room fills to 400 enrolled students. The middle and high school block adds two more weekday cohorts, lifting the ceiling to six times room capacity. The operating goal is to fill every cohort to capacity, then reprice.

New York runs two rooms. 180 Maiden Lane, the main campus, holds 100 seats, 400 enrolled. 156 William Street, the Early Learning Center, holds 30 seats, 120 enrolled, and is the early-years room: the youngest Alpha Hours students, kindergarten through second grade, in the building already set up for them, with the older students at Maiden Lane. Both buildings are in the Financial District, blocks apart, and share one Campus Coordinator.

Enrollment

Five sessions a year, each about seven weeks (about 35 program weeks). Families sign up one session at a time, choosing a weekday track or a Saturday block, with a one-session minimum and a \$500 non-refundable deposit at sign-up applied to the session fee. They re-enroll session to session, and re-enrollment for the next session opens in week 4 of the current one, before the general public. Families who want the year buy it: five sessions prepaid at \$22,500 holds the seat

and the track for the year, with first pick of cohort. No discount for prepaying, no sibling discount. Seats are scarce and priced accordingly.

Current Alpha students enroll on the same terms at the same session price with a 5 percent family discount. From the sixth session, every seat reprices to the continuation rate, \$5,000 per session in premium markets and \$4,000 standard, unless the family has a completed Alpha application on file, in which case the year-one rate holds. Nobody is required to apply. The application is the discount. No family is exited for staying. Where a cohort holds a waitlist, families with applications on file hold their seats and families without release them first. Current Alpha students are exempt from both. One session at a time lowers the barrier to trying Alpha and cycles far more distinct families through each seat than an annual plan, and the annual plan captures the families who already know they are staying.

Real estate

The building is a sunk cost Alpha already carries, whether it owns the campus or leases it, with after-hours and weekend access either way. Late-afternoon and Saturday use adds only marginal cost. Marginal cost about \$150 to \$250 per weekday, about \$400 per Saturday (custodial, HVAC and lighting, security). Because the host is an Alpha campus, the facility fee is largely intracompany.

Team

Head of Alpha Hours: \$400,000. Owns strategy, pricing, national rollout, campus relationships, guide hiring and training, and the full P&L. Reviewed every session on revenue, site profit, and re-enrollment; reports full-time Alpha enrollments as the upside line.

Operations and Admin VP: \$200,000. A remote role supporting every campus, and the Head of Alpha Hours' right hand: the Head owns strategy, growth, hiring, and the P&L, the VP runs the machine underneath it.

For each campus, the VP: Runs registration end to end: session sign-ups, lane tagging, cohort placement, waitlists, repricing, and the roster handoff to the Campus Coordinator before every session. Executes compliance: secures the written state exemption determination before the campus opens, keeps it current, and verifies every hire's background checks are complete before day one. Places and maintains insurance per site: general liability, professional liability, workers' compensation, and sexual abuse and molestation coverage. Drafts and manages the host-campus facility-use agreement, and coordinates access, security, and custodial arrangements with campus leadership. Procures centrally: laptops, supplies, and Alpha Hours Emporium

inventory, shipped to the Campus Coordinator. Reports weekly to the Head: fill rate by cohort and lane, attendance, re-enrollment, revenue, waitlist depth, and a consolidated per-site P&L.

Across the network, the VP builds the launch checklist every new campus runs, manages the launch calendar with the Head, and prepares the reporting the Head takes to leadership. One remote VP covers the full pilot, and the role adds operations support underneath it as the national footprint grows.

Campus Coordinator per campus: part-time, a 50 percent role at \$50,000. Inventory, responsible for laptop set-up and student accounts, coordination between admin and guides. A strong candidate pool is public school teachers looking for work: organized, experienced with children and school operations, and available in every metro. Coordinators run operations. New York's two buildings share one.

Dedicated Alpha Hours guides: part-time, working only for Alpha Hours, at \$50,000 a year. Weekdays run about 2.75 hours (3:30 to 6:15 with setup and dismissal), four days a week, plus a roughly 10-hour Saturday, about 21 staff-hours a week. Every guide completes the Alpha Hours training program before running a room: shadowing at Alpha NYC and an AI-first asynchronous training course. Guides are hired for their experience with children and trained out of teaching; the core discipline of the role is restraint. Guide hiring and training are owned by the Head of Alpha Hours.

Lead Guide per campus: \$75,000. Manages the guides, in charge of onboarding and overall programming. Same number of working hours as guides, about 21 hours a week. Every building has one, William Street included.

Staffing: about 1 guide per 10 students, two-adult minimum, extra attention to the youngest. The same team serves all four cohorts.

Compliance

Design and market as academic instruction, not childcare, to qualify for state exemptions. Avoid meals where they trigger licensing (Florida especially). Sign a formal host-campus facility-use agreement. Get a written exemption determination per state before opening: New York, Connecticut, Massachusetts, and Illinois before Session 2. Every block is curriculum-driven instruction end to end: timed mastery-academics sessions on Timeback and a structured life skills workshop. Flag the Saturday format and the break-week format specifically in each state's written exemption request.

FBI background checks on every hire: fingerprint criminal check, national sex offender registry, state child-abuse registry. Minimum two adults on site at all times.

Insurance: general liability, professional liability, workers' compensation, and sexual abuse and molestation coverage (excluded from most general liability policies, must be added).

Pricing

Per session, priced on value not hours. Standard markets: \$3,500 per session, \$17,500 per year. Premium markets: \$4,500 per session, \$22,500 per year. Current Alpha families: same session price with a 5 percent discount (\$4,275 premium, \$3,325 standard). Every pilot campus is priced at the premium tier (\$4,500), Chicago included, matching the national capacity model. Continuation rate from the sixth session: \$5,000 premium, \$4,000 standard, waived to the year-one rate for families with an Alpha application on file. Break weeks: \$4,500 a week. Waitlist repricing: any cohort that closes a session with a waitlist reprices by \$500 for the following session.

We sell a product and measurable academic outcomes, not hours. A session is four hours a week for seven weeks, about 28 hours. At \$4,500 that is roughly \$161 an hour, just under elite 1:1 tutors (\$200 to \$300), who cover one subject; we cover multiple, supervised, with the data to prove progress. A single session is four to five times the most expensive mainstream competitor for the same span. The full year is roughly a third (30 to 40 percent) of full Alpha tuition (\$40,000 to \$75,000). We quote the session and full-year numbers, not the hour.

The price point is already market-tested: 174 paid Alpha Summer registrations at \$4,500 per week, one price objection in 174 transactions. At \$4,500 per seven-week session, Alpha Hours is the same number for seven times the duration.

Financials

All figures at list price, premium tier (\$4,500 per session, five sessions), K-8 blocks only unless stated. The 5 percent current-family discount trims totals by 1 to 2 percent depending on mix. Break weeks and the middle and high school block are shown separately as additions. The standalone financials document carries the full model; this section is the summary.

Unit economics per campus

Revenue = enrolled x \$4,500 x 5 sessions. Enrolled = room capacity x 4.

Per-student cost per session: Timeback \$150, the extrinsic motivation model (Alpha bucks redeemed in the Emporium, inventory at cost) \$40, supplies \$15, snacks \$30, the child's share of the AlphaTest Showcase (printed mastery map and certificate) \$5, payment processing 3 percent (\$135), local marketing \$60. About \$435 per student per session, \$2,175 per student per year.

Guides: 1 per 10 concurrent seats, part-time at \$50,000 (roughly 21 hours a week), so a campus carries seats divided by 10 guides: 10 at a 100-seat room, 52 at Chicago's 517. The same guide serves all four cohorts, so one guide supports up to 40 enrolled students, about \$1,250 of guide cost per enrolled student at even fill, \$250 a session.

Per-campus fixed cost: Lead Guide \$75,000, Campus Coordinator \$50,000 (50 percent role), facility about \$45,000 a year, insurance about \$8,000, and the AlphaTest Showcase events at \$2,000 per campus per session (four cohort showcases), \$10,000 a year. About \$188,000 a year, charged only for the sessions a campus is open. William Street shares New York's coordinator, so its fixed cost is about \$138,000.

Contribution per enrolled student: \$20,325 a year (\$4,500 less \$435, times five), \$19,075 after guides at even fill. Margin runs about 82 percent at capacity, higher at larger campuses where the fixed team spreads over more revenue.

Pilot campuses at capacity

Campus	Opens	Seats	Enrolled	Guides	Revenue a year	Site profit	Margin
New York, 180 Maiden Lane	Session 2	100	400	10	\$9.00M	\$7.44M	83%
New York, 156 William Street	Session 2	30	120	3	\$2.70M	\$2.15M	80%
Greenwich (Armonk)	Session 3	80	320	8	\$7.20M	\$5.92M	82%
Boston A	Session 3	40	160	4	\$3.60M	\$2.86M	80%
Boston B	Session 3	100	400	10	\$9.00M	\$7.44M	83%
Chicago	Session 4	517	2,068	52	\$46.53M	\$39.24M	84%
Miami	Session 4	150	600	15	\$13.50M	\$11.26M	83%
Palm Beach	Session 4	60	240	6	\$5.40M	\$4.39M	81%
Miami Beach	Session 4	50	200	5	\$4.50M	\$3.63M	81%
Launch total, Session 2 (New York)		130	520	13	\$11.70M	\$9.59M	82%
Session 3 total (plus Greenwich, Boston)		350	1,400	35	\$31.50M	\$25.82M	82%
Full pilot total, Sessions 4 and 5		1,127	4,508	113	\$101.43M	\$84.33M	83%

New York alone is \$11.7M a year at capacity, \$9.6M site profit, 520 enrolled across two buildings.

Per session at capacity: \$2.34M revenue and \$1.92M site profit in Session 2, \$6.30M and \$5.16M in Session 3, \$20.29M and \$16.87M from Session 4. Less the central team (\$700K base, about \$875K fully loaded), the full pilot run rate nets about \$83.5M a year.

Year 1 by session, three cases

Year 1 is four sessions, Sessions 2 through 5. The footprint steps up each session: New York in Session 2, Greenwich and Boston from Session 3, Chicago and Florida from Session 4. Guides are hired to sold seats, so guide cost scales with fill; fixed cost is charged per open campus.

Capacity is the ceiling. Plan is the number the Head is held to: each campus fills 60 percent in its first session, 75 percent in its second, 90 percent in its third, and 100 percent from its fourth, so New York is full by Session 5 while Chicago and Florida are at 75 percent. Floor is every cohort at 25 percent fill all year, roughly the level at which the cohort floor would start closing cohorts.

Session	Dates	Campuses open	Enrolled, plan	Revenue, capacity	Revenue, plan	\$
Session 2	Oct 19 to Dec 18, 2026	2	312	\$2.34M	\$1.40M	
Session 3	Jan 4 to Feb 19, 2027	5	918	\$6.30M	\$4.13M	
Session 4	Feb 24 to Apr 16, 2027	9	2,993	\$20.29M	\$13.47M	
Session 5	Apr 26 to Jun 18, 2027	9	3,643	\$20.29M	\$16.39M	
Year 1 total				\$49.21M	\$35.40M	

Year 1 case	Revenue	Site profit	Net after central team
Capacity (100 percent at every open campus)	\$49.2M	\$40.8M	\$39.9M
Plan (60 / 75 / 90 / 100 by each campus's own session count)	\$35.4M	\$29.0M	\$28.2M
Floor (25 percent all year)	\$12.3M	\$9.5M	\$8.6M

Even the floor case clears about \$8.6M net in Year 1, because the cost base is part-time staff hired to sold seats inside buildings Alpha already pays for. The exit run rate matters more than the Year 1 total: leaving Session 5 at plan, the pilot is running at \$16.4M a session, \$82M a year, before the national launch.

Year 1 additions

Break week, April 19 to 23, 2027: 1,127 seats across the pilot at \$4,500 a week, \$5.1M revenue at capacity, about \$4.6M profit (a full-day guide week and supplies are the only costs). Two break weeks a year from Year 2, about \$10.1M on the pilot footprint.

Middle and high school block, from Session 4 (February 24, 2027) at New York Maiden Lane and Greenwich: two more cohorts per campus, 200 enrolled at Maiden Lane and 160 at Greenwich, \$8.1M a year of run rate, \$3.2M inside Year 1 across Sessions 4 and 5 at capacity. Every pilot campus adds it in Fall 2027, which lifts the pilot ceiling by 2,254 enrolled and \$50.7M a year.

Year 1 pilot with additions, at capacity: about \$57M revenue. At plan: about \$44M.

Revenue by lane

The room is the same in every lane, so revenue per seat is the same. What the lane changes is tenure, and what the family is worth beyond the session fee. The plan is sized on Stay. Mix is a modeled assumption for the pilot: Stay 70 percent, Considering 15 percent, Path to yes 5 percent, current Alpha families 10 percent. Session 2 replaces it with the measured split. Figures at full pilot capacity, 4,508 enrolled.

Lane	Share	Families	Session revenue a year	What else the family is worth
Stay (the business)	70%	3,156	\$71.0M	Tenure. Three years at year-one then continuation rates is \$72,500 a family, before break weeks. Five years is \$122,500.
Considering (upside)	15%	676	\$15.2M	Conversion. Two sessions (\$9,000) plus a 20 percent conversion at \$240,000 lifetime tuition is \$57,000 expected per family, and the non-converters move to Stay.
Path to yes (upside)	5%	225	\$5.1M	Admission on data. Three sessions (\$13,500) plus a modeled 20 percent admit rate at \$240,000 is \$61,500 expected per family.
Current Alpha	10%	451	\$9.6M (after 5 percent discount)	Retention. The school day no longer ends at 3:30.

Seventy percent of the revenue comes from families who will never enroll, and it is the most durable 70 percent: nothing about their reason for not enrolling changes year to year. Conversion rates are modeled, not measured. The program clears its P&L at zero conversions, so every conversion is upside on top of the session revenue above.

Downside economics

Contribution per enrolled student is about \$20,325 a year before guides. Minimum operating cost per campus is about \$288K, so break-even is 15 enrolled students per campus, about 4 per cohort, under 4 percent of full capacity at the largest sites. Enrollment closes before each session starts and guides are hired to sold seats, so every staffing step is taken against booked revenue, and site margin holds between 72 and 83 percent at every fill level above break-even. Exposure is capped by design: one-session enrollment, part-time staff, no capex, and a building Alpha already pays for mean the maximum downside at any site is seven weeks of payroll.

Two mechanical floors sit under it. Cohort floor: a cohort that has not sold 10 seats two weeks before session start (October 5, 2026 for Session 2) does not open, and its families roll into the other weekday track or a Saturday block. Site floor: a campus below break-even at week 3 of its first session (the week of November 2 for New York) closes at session end, staff released, room returned to the campus. Week 3 is the checkpoint because attendance and re-enrollment intent, the program's own leading indicators, are both visible by then.

The national build

The build runs in steps behind the New York launch, one session apart through the pilot year, then the national launch with the 2027–28 school year. Capacity figures.

Step	Session	Campuses added	Seats added	Enrolled added	Run rate added	Run rate
Launch	Session 2, Oct 2026	New York (2)	130	520	\$11.7M	\$11.7M
Step 2	Session 3, Jan 2027	Greenwich, Boston (2)	220	880	\$19.8M	\$31.5M
Step 3	Session 4, Feb 2027	Chicago (517), Miami, Palm Beach, Miami Beach	777	3,108	\$69.9M	\$101.4M
Hold	Session 5, Apr 2027	None: a full session on nine campuses with no new openings	0	0		\$101.4M
National	Session 1, Fall 2027	Austin (300) and every remaining campus, about 30 at a conservative 50 seats each	1,850	7,400	\$166.5M	\$267.9M

Full network at capacity, about 40 campuses, K–8 blocks only: 11,908 enrolled, \$267.9M revenue, about \$220M site profit (about 82 percent), about \$216M net after central team. Chicago: 2,068 enrolled, \$46.5M. Austin: 1,200 enrolled, \$27M. New York: 520 enrolled, \$11.7M. The middle and high school block lifts every participating campus ceiling by 50 percent from Fall 2027, a path toward \$400M+ at full capacity, and two break weeks a year across 2,977 seats add about \$27M. Year 2 at 75 percent network fill with the evening block and break weeks: about \$271M revenue, about \$221M net. Year 3 at 90 percent: about \$356M, about \$292M.

Market size

TAM about \$40B a year: what US families already spend on tutoring and after-school combined (\$18.9B tutoring, \$21.0B after-school), before any category growth. SAM about \$16B a year: the share of that spend in Alpha's metros, roughly 40 percent of premium households. SOM today about \$268M a year: the full 40-campus network at capacity on K-8 blocks, about 1.7 percent of SAM. The constraint is buildings, and Alpha adds about 20 a year.

The feeder (upside)

One conversion to full Alpha is worth \$160,000 to \$325,000 in lifetime tuition. Modeled conversion 4 to 8 percent of all enrolled families, most of it from the Considering and Path to yes lanes, replaced by our own measured number after Session 2. Nothing in the plan depends on it. The program is profitable at zero conversions, so the effective acquisition cost per full enrollment is negative.

Feeder sensitivity. At a \$240,000 midpoint lifetime tuition value, on the full pilot's 4,508 enrolled at capacity: 4 percent conversion is 180 enrollments, about \$43M; 8 percent is 361, about \$87M; 12 percent is 541, about \$130M. On the full national base of 11,908 enrolled: 4 percent is about \$114M, 8 percent about \$229M, 12 percent about \$343M. That is lifetime tuition, booked by the school over years, on top of a program that clears its own P&L in its first session.

Potential Objections and Challenges

Reputation, and why New York goes first, alone

Alpha Hours will be many families' first Alpha experience, and it carries the school's brand into every one of them. A weak session damages the school and the feeder, not just the program. The earlier plan answered that by holding New York out of the pilot for a year. This plan answers it the other way: New York opens first, and opens alone, so the model is proven in the one market the Head can watch every day before any other building opens. The controls are the same at every campus that follows: the guide training program runs at Alpha NYC, so New York's guides are the best-trained in the network and every later campus inherits the program; guides are staffed to sold seats so no room ever opens understaffed; the Lead Guide owns quality in every building; the week-1 exit process protects every room from the one child who would wreck it; and the AlphaTest Showcase puts the proof on a stage every seven weeks. New York is also where the

Head sits, where the demand was measured, and where the sales list already exists. The market that can be watched most closely is the right one to open first.

Wrong-fit students, and the week 1 exit process

One student who cannot function in a 1:10 room destroys the product for the nine other families who paid \$4,500, and at this price that is not survivable. So the exit trigger is behavioral and mechanical, not a judgment call. Two things trigger it: behavior, every incident that pulls a guide off the room, disrupting another student's session, refusing to remain in the block, is logged the moment it happens, and two logged incidents in week 1 is an exit before week 2. And level of support, a child who requires a level of individual support that compromises the program's ability to deliver the three commitments, kids love school, learn 2x, learn life skills, to the rest of the room. The Head of Alpha Hours delivers the decision to the family, the log makes it. The family receives the incident record and a prorated refund. Both standards are published at enrollment, so an exit is the program enforcing what every family in the room paid for.

Students who need 1:1 support

The staffing model is 1 guide per 10 students, and it cannot deliver one-to-one support. This is publicly listed on the landing page before any family pays: Alpha Hours cannot accommodate students who need 1:1 support. Stating it up front protects the ratio, sets expectations honestly, and filters at the top of the funnel instead of in week 1.

The arrival window for non-Alpha students

Outside schools dismiss around 3:00, and drop-off closes at 4:00. For most target families this is routine, and for the rest the two Saturday blocks carry the load. The window is held at 15 minutes on purpose: the block starts on time for everyone, every time.

Saturday competes with youth sports

Saturday morning is prime league time in exactly our demographic. Two Saturday blocks, two weekday tracks, and session-at-a-time enrollment let families rotate around sports seasons instead of choosing against them permanently.

The parking risk

Some families will treat Alpha Hours as Alpha at a third of the price and delay full enrollment. For most of them that is the product, that is the plan, and they are Stay customers worth \$22,500 a year for years. The program is built for them. For the family that would have enrolled full-time, the structured conversion conversation, the mastery map, and the weeks-to-grade-level projection make the ceiling explicit: 100 minutes a week produces the map, full Alpha produces the acceleration. And from the sixth session the seat reprices to \$5,000 unless an application is on file, so a long-stayer is either pipeline by definition or premium revenue, and where a waitlist stands, non-applicants release the seat first.

This is a tutoring business competing with the school

Yes, it is a business, and it is built to be one: sized on families who will never enroll, staffed to sold seats, and judged on fill and re-enrollment. It does not compete with the school, because the families it serves were never going to enroll, and the ones who were get a paid trial, a mastery map, and a data-triggered invitation instead of a free shadow day. The school loses nothing and gains a revenue line, full buildings, and a stream of applicants who have already paid to be evaluated.

One market in Session 2 is slow

It is one session, seven weeks, and it buys the number every later decision runs on: a measured New York fill, re-enrollment and lane mix, from the two buildings the Head can walk to. Greenwich and Boston open the very next session on that number, Chicago and Florida the session after, and the whole network the following fall. Nothing waits a year. What the sequence changes is that every campus opens on a playbook that has already run once, with guides trained in a room that is already working, and the cohort and site floors decide which campuses open small and which open full without a meeting. The pilot still ends Year 1 at nine campuses, 1,127 seats and a \$101M run rate at capacity, and enters the national launch with four sessions of data instead of one.

Guide supply at national scale

Guide hiring and training are owned by the Head of Alpha Hours. The candidate pool, public school teachers and retired teachers, exists at scale in every metro, and the Alpha Hours training program, shadowing at Alpha NYC plus AI-first asynchronous training, standardizes quality before any guide runs a room.

Rollout

Session 2 (October 19 to December 18, 2026): New York, sold to the whole city

180 Maiden Lane (100 seats) and 156 William Street (30 seats), both buildings, all four cohorts on sale, no cap and no small-group phase: the launch enrolls every family New York will buy, in every lane. 130 seats, 520 enrolled at capacity, an \$11.7M run rate.

Sales open in September to the whole city, not the funnel: the 1,000-plus HubSpot families from the Hamptons outreach, the 174 paid Hamptons families, and the parent networks of every school in the Financial District, sold as the best after-school program in the city and nothing else. The admissions pipeline is the second list: every New York family who was not a yes gets a Path to yes seat or a Considering seat with the not-yet letter. Current Alpha families are the base load. Cohort floor decision October 5. Week-3 checkpoint the week of November 2. Re-enrollment for Session 3 opens in week 4, the week of November 9, to enrolled families first.

Launching at Session 2 rather than Session 1 gives the campus a settled start to the school year and the runway for guide hiring, the New York exemption determination, and insurance. Quality is carried by the guide training program at Alpha NYC, the Lead Guide in each building, and guides hired to sold seats so no room opens understaffed. While New York runs, Greenwich and Boston hire and train their guides in the New York rooms, and Connecticut and Massachusetts exemptions are filed alongside New York's in September.

Pilot success criteria and measurement plan

The pilot succeeds on two measured numbers: session-over-session re-enrollment at or above 70 percent, and plan fill (60 percent in a campus's first session, 75 percent in its second). Those are the business. Conversion to full Alpha is the upside, modeled at 4 to 8 percent of all enrolled families, and it is measured with the same rigor without being a pass or fail condition. The experiment is instrumented before it opens, in five commitments.

1. The lanes and the funnel are defined before Session 2 starts. Every family is tagged to a lane at enrollment. Conversion is not one number; it is tracked per family through six stages: paid Alpha Hours enrollment, structured conversion conversation held, application submitted, admitted, full-Alpha enrollment signed, first tuition payment. Stage-level tracking is what says whether a weak result is a marketing problem, an admissions problem, or a product problem. Stay families are tracked on tenure, not conversion.

2. The trigger is mechanical. The thresholds that fire the conversion conversation and the application invitation, mastery gains, and session completion rate, are published before Session 2 opens, so the measured rate reflects the product, not the persuasiveness of whichever Lead Guide ran the conversation that week.
3. The number is lift, not a raw count. Conversion is measured against a matched baseline of non-Alpha-Hours inquiries from the same markets and the same window, because some share of these families would have applied anyway, and the case rests on what Alpha Hours adds, not on conversions that were coming regardless.
4. Sample size is respected. Session 2's 520 New York families are reported as directional, with the margin of error stated; the read widens to 1,400 families in Session 3 and 4,508 from Session 4. Every number is reported by campus, by cohort, by lane, by session count, and by market, and a material spread between markets is treated as a market-mix finding that reshapes the sequence, not noise to average away.
5. The decision rule is pre-committed, and it runs on the business, not on conversion. Each step is released at the week-3 checkpoint of the session before it: Greenwich and Boston at the Session 2 checkpoint (week of November 2) if New York fill is at or above 40 percent and neither building is below its site floor; Chicago and Florida at the Session 3 checkpoint (week of January 18) on the same test plus Session 2 re-enrollment at or above 60 percent; the national launch at the Session 5 checkpoint (week of May 10) on plan fill across the pilot and Year 1 re-enrollment at or above 70 percent. Conversion below 6 percent does not pause the build; it triggers a funnel-stage review and moves the admissions conversation, not the program. Above 10 percent, the feeder becomes the lead story to leadership. Each checkpoint conversation is the numbers and what they trigger, not another debate.

Session 3 (January 4, 2027): Greenwich and Boston

Greenwich (Armonk, 80 seats) and both Boston campuses (40 and 100) open on the New York playbook, with guides trained in the New York rooms during Session 2 and one shared coordinator pool across the corridor. 350 seats, 1,400 enrolled, a \$31.5M run rate at capacity. New York enters its second session at 75 percent plan fill with a Session 3 waitlist built against Session 2. Illinois and Florida exemption requests, which flag meals and the break-week format, are filed in November.

Session 4 (February 24, 2027): Chicago, Florida, and the evening block in New York and Greenwich

Chicago opens at its expanded 517 seats, the network's largest room, with two sessions of operating data behind it: this is the national build in miniature, the same playbook at five times the scale of any East Coast room. Miami (150), Palm Beach (60) and Miami Beach (50) open the same session. Nine campuses, 1,127 seats, 4,508 enrolled, a \$101.4M run rate at capacity. The middle and high school block opens the same session at New York Maiden Lane and Greenwich, 6:15 to 8:15 pm, adding 360 enrolled and \$8.1M of run rate.

Session 5 (April 26 to June 18, 2027): hold and prove

No new openings. Nine campuses run a full session, the first break week runs April 19 to 23 across the pilot (\$5.1M at capacity), and the pilot leaves the year at plan fill of \$16.4M a session, an \$82M run rate, with four sessions of measured fill, re-enrollment and conversion in five markets. The Session 5 week-3 checkpoint, the week of May 10, releases the national launch, which gives every remaining campus the summer to hire and train.

Session 1, Fall 2027: national launch

Austin (300 seats) and every remaining campus, about 30 at a conservative 50 seats, open with the 2027-28 school year on a playbook that has run four times. Network: about 40 campuses, 2,977 seats, 11,908 enrolled on K-8 blocks, \$267.9M run rate at capacity. The middle and high school block launches at every pilot campus the same fall, and two break weeks a year become standard at every campus. The network grows with every new campus Alpha opens, about 20 a year.

Why this order

New York first because it is the network's most valuable pipeline and its best-instrumented market: measured unprompted demand, a proven \$4,500 price, the guide training site, the Head on the ground, and two buildings blocks apart that let the youngest students run in the room built for them. Greenwich and Boston second because they are dense UHNW markets at premium tuition, close enough to New York that one launch team and a shared guide pool cover five buildings, and every conversion there is worth the most. Chicago and Florida third because Chicago is the network's largest campus, 517 seats and 2,068 enrolled at capacity, so the pilot tests the model at the exact scale the national build depends on, in a market outside the East Coast corridor, and the three Florida campuses add the second-largest market with its own

licensing regime, so the national playbook has been through both before it goes everywhere. Session 5 holds so the national launch is decided on a full year of data, not a partial one, and lands with the school year instead of mid-year. In every one of these cities, the families who will never enroll at Alpha outnumber the ones who will by more than ten to one. That is who the program is for.

Alpha's learning-speed and test-score figures cited throughout are Alpha's own internal data and are not independently audited.